

MODULE 13 WORKSHEET

Paid-Pilot Conversion

Reduce the client's risk with a small, clearly scoped paid engagement instead of overselling a large retainer.

Completion target: define a bounded pilot with objective, target, deliverables, client responsibilities, metrics, duration, compensation, payment terms, and review point.

Do not use a paid pilot as a disguised guarantee. You control process quality and activity; you do not control every prospect, offer, closer, market condition, or final revenue outcome.

1. Pilot fit check

- ☐ Client has a real offer and target customer.
- ☐ Client can explain what a qualified opportunity means.
- ☐ There is enough market to test.
- ☐ Client will provide required access / information.
- ☐ Compensation and payment terms can be written clearly.
- ☐ The work is something I can actually deliver.

2. Pilot objective

Business problem:

Pilot objective:

3. Scope builder

Element	Definition
Target ICP	
Geography	
Target roles	
Channels	
Research volume / activity	
Outreach activity	
Follow-up	
Qualification rule	
CRM / reporting	
Excluded work	

Recommended pilot length

Usually 5-10 working days for a small beginner pilot, adjusted when the sales cycle or channel requires more time.

Chosen duration and reason:

4. Client responsibilities

- ☐ Offer / pricing context
- ☐ ICP / exclusions
- ☐ Approved claims and proof
- ☐ CRM / calendar access where required
- ☐ Prompt approval of messaging
- ☐ Escalation contact
- ☐ Clear do-not-contact / compliance rules
- ☐ Payment according to written terms

Other client responsibility:

5. Pilot metrics

Metric	Target / tracking rule	Why it matters
Research quality		
Activity		
Reach / replies		
Positive interest		
Qualified meetings		
Prospect feedback / objections		

6. Compensation and payment

Structure	Selected?	Notes
Hourly		
Fixed paid pilot		
Base + performance incentive		
Commission-only		Use cautiously; attribution and timing must be clear.

Pilot price / rate:

Payment timing:

Payment method:

Commission-only safety check

- ☐ Attribution is trackable.
- ☐ Definition of earned commission is written.
- ☐ Payment timing is written.
- ☐ Refund/cancellation effects are clear.
- ☐ I trust the client's reporting.

7. One-page pilot proposal

Current problem:

Target outcome:

Scope:

Deliverables:

Client provides:

Metrics / reporting:

Duration:

Price / payment:

Review / decision point:

8. Pilot close rehearsal

Practice a concise close:

"Based on what you've described, I'd keep the first step small. I can run a paid pilot focused on [target], with [deliverables]. We'll track [metrics] and review the results at the end. If the process is useful, we can decide whether to continue."

My version:

Common responses

Client response	Your next action
"Too expensive."	
"Can you work for free first?"	
"Can you guarantee meetings / sales?"	
"Let's do commission only."	
"Send the proposal."	

9. Pre-agreement red-flag check

- ☐ No deceptive claims or impersonation required.
- ☐ Scope is written.
- ☐ Payment terms are written.
- ☐ The client is not asking me to pay to get the job.
- ☐ Large unpaid production test is not required.
- ☐ Access requests are legitimate and secure.
- ☐ I understand what I am representing to prospects.
- ☐ I can exit cleanly if the pilot is not a fit.

10. Acceptance checklist

- ☐ Scope accepted.
- ☐ Compensation accepted.
- ☐ Payment timing accepted.
- ☐ Start point agreed.
- ☐ Required access identified.
- ☐ Primary contact identified.
- ☐ Review point agreed.

MODULE 13 QUALITY GATE

Paid-Pilot Conversion - PASS / REVISE

- ☐ Pilot objective is clear.
- ☐ Scope is bounded.
- ☐ Client responsibilities are explicit.
- ☐ Metrics measure the work fairly.
- ☐ Compensation and payment timing are clear.
- ☐ The proposal avoids guarantees outside my control.
- ☐ Red flags were checked.
- ☐ I can explain the pilot without reading the proposal.
- ☐ I can directly ask for the next step.

Result	PASS / REVISE
Proposal status	DRAFT / READY / SENT / ACCEPTED
Required correction	